Stanley never found out either. I asked him recently and he didn't know. Marcia doesn't know, either.

Nor, after that day, did I ever see Uncle Joe or Aunt Pauline again. I presume they are dead by now, but if they are I do not know when they died or under what circumstances.

The year 1952 drew to a close and during its course I had published no less than four books, as many as I had in 1950 and 1951 put together. They were:

5. David Starr: Space Ranger (Doubleday)

6. Foundation and Empire (Gnome)

7. The Currents of Space (Doubleday)

8. Biochemistry and Human Metabolism (Williams & Wilkins)

Biochemistry and Human Metabolism was a collaboration, of course, but even one third of that book was longer (and certainly harder work) than any of the other seven books on the list, so I had no compunction in listing it as among "my" books. And, of course, the fact that David Starr: Space Ranger was under a pseudonym made no difference as far as I was concerned.

As for my writing earnings, the figure for 1952 reached an astonishing $8,550, nearly twice as much as the previous record year of 1950, and more than I had earned in all the years, put together, prior to the publication of Pebble in the Sky.

What was more important was that it was half again my school earnings of $5,500. (I couldn't help but feel a distinct triumph over that stupid dentist at Breadloaf. Amazing how small irritations linger even after large misfortunes fade.)

Just as my parents were now out from under, so also was I. I was out from under any feeling of financial dependence on my school position. I worried no further about how much they were paying me, and I could concentrate on more basic demands without worrying about being fired (and the main demand, of course, was to get out from under Lemon).

Furthermore, with a total income of over $14,000 for the year 1952, I got out from under the specter of economic insecurity. I wasn't certain that life could go on without catastrophe—who could be?—but barring acts of God, there